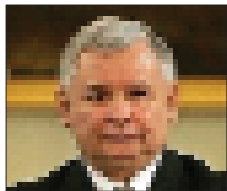




98 DVD / DivX
Players Tested



108 Game on



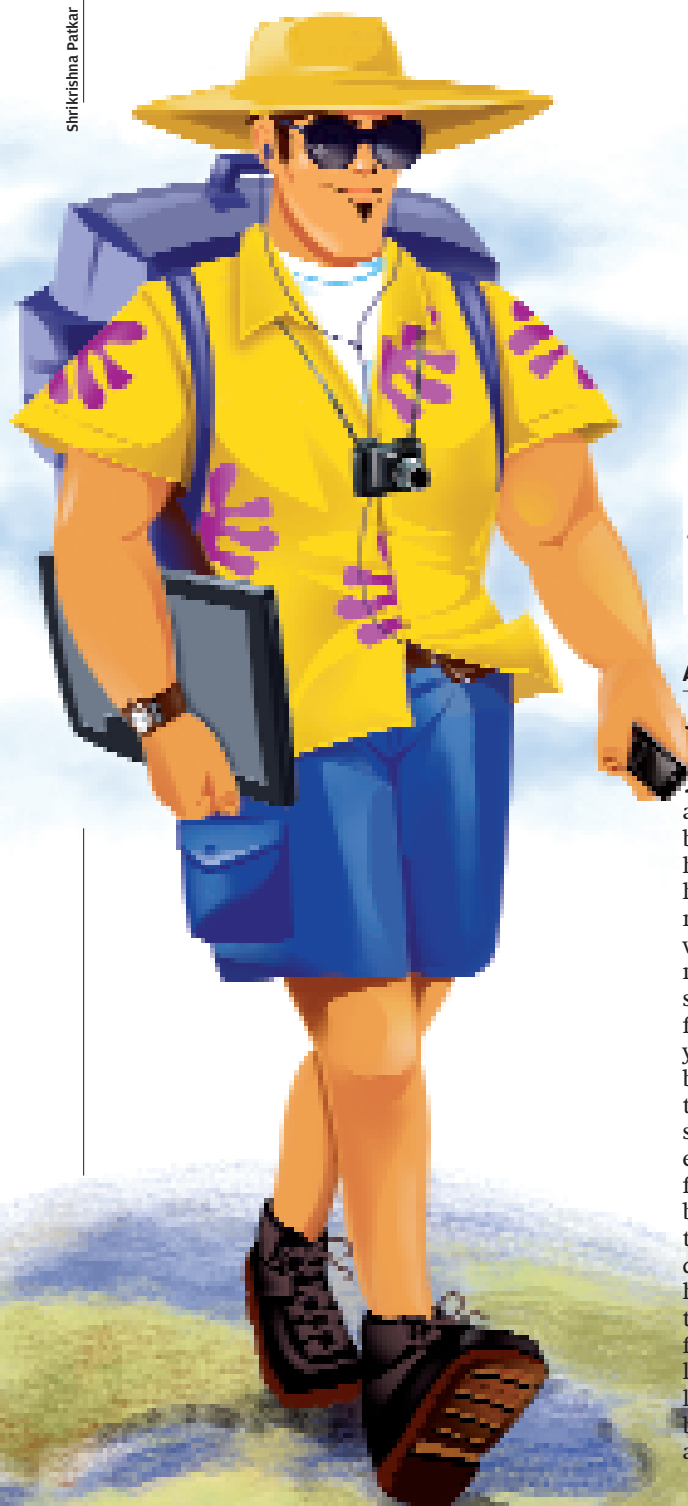
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Digital Leisure

Technology Beyond Work

Lead Feature

Shrikrishna Patkar



Geek's Week Out

I finally got some much deserved, and much needed time off from my hectic, do good existence. Two weeks off!—here's how it was spent, and with whom...

Agent 001

Even techies need a vacation, right? I rarely get time off, and even your beloved agent is susceptible to stress. It's been a long time since I went on holiday, and my diligence and hard work this past year was rewarded with a whole two weeks off! Two weeks to recharge my batteries, two weeks of de-stressing and rejuvenation, all for the humble goal of serving you, my beloved reader, a little better. Sadly I couldn't afford a trip abroad having spent all my spare cash on gadgets (what else?), and exotic locations and fast cars are more 007 dominion, but as 001 I have my standards too! I wanted something outdoors, something away from the hustle and bustle of urbanisation. I was thinking calm peaceful waters, greenery, wildlife, a little adventure, and mostly isolation. Kerala and its beautiful backwaters I have seen before, and having become accustomed

to the warm and cosy environs of Mumbai, the cold (brrrr!) north was out. After a bit of googling, and searching through each state's official tourism Web site, I finally decided on the so-called heart of India—Madhya Pradesh (MP). I googled quite a bit on the local people, places of interest, climatic conditions (my proposed visit is around the beginning of April). So two days into my holiday and I was all set.

I decided to visit the capital city Bhopal first—it's supposed to be the city of lakes as well as being steeped in history. I booked my ticket online courtesy my account at www.makemytrip.com, and 3,500 bucks off my credit card later I was on my way. As exciting as a holiday is, especially when you're taking one after more than a year, I took my time making a list of the stuff that I would need for the trip, and took a printout of the same, which was pasted atop my fridge for reference.

I needed something to enable productivity on the go, and I was torn between notebook and PDA.